

FOUNDING BLUEPRINT · THE COMPLETE OPERATING & LEARNING MODEL

The Itqan Way

From Vision to a Working School

A new Islamic secondary school (Stages 4–6), Sydney — a model in which knowledge, action and faith are one journey, not three subjects. The named model, what learning looks like in practice per year level, how industry plugs in, the technology, the staffing and real NSW salaries, the pathways, and the foundation & risk plan.

Prepared for Dr Khaled Altarawneh · Head of School (Founding Appointment) candidacy

How to read the numbers in this document

Four kinds of figure appear, and they are flagged so the Board can trust them: **NESA facts** (registration mechanics, mandatory hours, requirements); **NSW salary figures** (NSW Department of Education teacher and leadership scale effective 9 October 2025, plus independent-sector loadings — real, current rates); **established practice** (patterns proven in named schools); and **planning assumptions** (staffing counts, ratios, time allocations and enrolment sizing — explicitly labelled). No invented dollar figures are presented as fact.

Part 1 · The model and its names

1.1 One journey — faith at the centre, not on the side

Most schools teach the mind in one room, character in another, and faith in a third. **The Itqan Way** refuses that split. Everything turns on a single principle — **Itqan**: excellence and perfection in whatever your hands turn to, performed as worship. From that centre, three things that are usually separated become one act:

The faculty	The Islamic frame	In our school
Mind	'Ilm — beneficial knowledge	The wellspring (Manhal)
Hands	'Amal — righteous action	Real projects in the real world ('Amal Projects + Kitab Maftuh)
Heart	Iman & Akhlaq — faith & character	Formed in the doing — evidenced in the Athar portfolio

The tradition does the connecting work for us: knowledge ('ilm) is incomplete until it becomes action ('amal); action is only worthy when done with excellence (*Itqan* / *Ihsan*); and the purpose of reading the world (*Iqra* — 'read the signs') is to flourish and serve. That is also, almost exactly, the project-based-learning sequence — learn → apply → reflect → contribute. Faith and pedagogy are saying the same thing, so a child practises faith-as-excellence in real contexts hundreds of times before they graduate. That habit, formed young, is what produces leaders who are capable *and* grounded.

1.2 Three design tests

Every decision — every node, project, hire, policy — must pass three tests: **Ihsan** (does it serve the learner and community with excellence, as a trust before the Divine?); **Authentic mastery** (does the learner genuinely understand and can they apply it, evidenced not assumed?); and **NESA assurance** (can we evidence that it meets or exceeds the mandatory outcome for the RoSA/HSC and inspection?).

1.3 A named architecture — explicit, faith-rooted, built to inspire

A founding school needs a language of its own. Each name is chosen so it carries its Islamic meaning *and* its exact pedagogical job at once — nothing decorative, everything translatable.

In the school	Name	Meaning · what it does · comparator
The whole model	The Itqan Way	Itqan = mastery/perfection of one's work as worship. The philosophy: do everything beautifully.
The wellspring	Manhal	'The Tree of Knowledge.' The self-paced, mastery-gated curriculum map. Mirrors the CSU topic tree.
The platform	Manara	'The lighthouse / minaret' — the guiding light. The digital home of the tree, portfolio and dashboards.
The projects	'Amal Projects	'Amal = righteous action. Knowledge turned into deeds — one real interdisciplinary project a term. Mirrors Gold-Standard PBL.
The real-world layer	Kitab Maftuh	'The Open Book' — the world and the city as an open book of God's signs. Studios, mosques, councils, workplaces as real learning sites. Mirrors Big Picture's 'Leaving to Learn.'
The portfolio	Athar	'The lasting trace one leaves.' The curated, defended body of evidence. Mirrors the Mastery Transcript / Portfolio of Learning.
Public exhibitions	Majlis	'The gathering.' Termly public showcase to family, mentors and community. Mirrors Exhibitions of Learning.
The home-group	Usrah	'The learning family.' The small belonging-group, 2+ years with one coach. Mirrors Big Picture's Advisory.
The coach	Murabbi / Murabbiyah	'One who nurtures the whole person' (from Tarbiyah). Owns each student's plan, portfolio and wellbeing.
Subject experts	Mu'allim / Mu'allimah	'The teacher.' Authors tree nodes, leads knowledge sprints (the Domain Guides).
The three stages	Talab · Tafaqquh · Riyadah	Seek (Talab — talab al-'ilm) → Deepen (Tafaqquh — deep understanding) → Lead (Riyadah — pioneering leadership & enterprise).

A respectful note: these terms are drawn from the Islamic tradition and should be reviewed with the school's scholars and community before adoption — that care is itself *adab*.

1.4 This is proven practice — comparable schools

School / network	Where & scale	What it proves
Charles Sturt Engineering	Australia — MIT-recognised	On-demand topic tree + project challenges + workplace learning + competency gating works (your direct experience).
Big Picture Learning Australia	40+ AU campuses, 15+ years (incl. NSW: Sydney Secondary College Leichhardt, Five Islands)	Advisory + internships + personalised plans + portfolios + exhibitions, at scale in the NSW public system.
Templestowe College	Victoria — ~1,000 students	Student-empowered, flexible-hours, mixed-cohort PBL revived a near-closed school; among Australia's most innovative.
High Tech High / XP / School 21	USA & UK	Rigorous interdisciplinary PBL, oracy and public exhibitions sustain inside national curricula/exams.
Mastery Transcript Consortium	USA, many schools	Universities accept competency/portfolio transcripts alongside grades.

The Big Picture Australia precedent matters most: this kind of model is already *registered and operating inside the NSW system*. We combine that proven practice with CSU's knowledge-tree rigour and an explicit Islamic foundation.

1.5 The hard constraints (NESA), in brief

Registration before opening (a 12-month provisional licence on 'capacity to comply'); applications due 31 March of the year before opening; nine Part-B requirements (B1 Proprietors/Principals · B2 Management & operation · B3 Staff · B4 Curriculum · B5 Premises · B6 Facilities · B7 Enrolment & attendance · B8 Safe & supportive environment · B9 Discipline); Part C for RoSA/HSC accreditation; mandatory hours (400 each of English, Mathematics, Science across Years 7–10, 100 of a language, plus PDHPE and the rest); all teaching by NESA-accredited teachers; a first-year inspection (Strand A welfare, Strand B teaching). NESA does *not* prescribe class sizes or staffing ratios — it requires accredited teachers covering the mandatory curriculum and safe supervision. That is the legal space in which this model's flexibility lives.

Part 2 · What learning looks like in practice, per stage

2.1 The weekly architecture and the modality mix

The week is built from blocks, not 40-minute single-subject periods. *Manhal* carries most content acquisition (asynchronous, on-demand, self-paced); the human time is reserved for what a video cannot do: **knowledge sprints** (scheduled, face-to-face, Guide-led explicit teaching); **'Amal Project studios** (collaborative project work); **self-paced Manhal time** (independent mastery, coach circulating); **Usrah** (daily home-family with the Murabbi); and **Kitab Maftuh** (off-site real-world learning). Students attend a structured, supervised week (NESA B7); the flexibility is in how the time is used, not whether they come.

2.2 Time per week, per stage (planning model)

Indicative split of a ~27-hour student week. The mix shifts from high structure toward independence as self-regulation matures; all hours map to NESA indicative outcome hours across the year.

Element	Talab · Seek (Y7-8)	Tafaqquh · Deepen (Y9-10)	Riyadah · Lead (Y11-12)
Knowledge sprints (F2F, Guide-led)	8 hr	6 hr	6 hr (HSC-focused)
Self-paced Manhal time	5 hr	7 hr	8 hr
'Amal Project studio	7 hr	7 hr	5 hr (capstone)
Usrah + coaching	3 hr	2.5 hr	2 hr
Kitab Maftuh (off-site / internship)	2 hr (visits)	4 hr (mentorship)	6 hr (internship, ~1 day)
Spiritual life, wellbeing, physical, creative	2 hr	0.5 hr	— (embedded)

Planning assumption — ratios and hours are a starting model, tuned against NESA indicative hours and the timetable.

2.3 Talab · Seek (Year 7-8) — a day in the life

Highest structure, mostly face-to-face. Aisha (Year 7) begins each day in her *Usrah* with her Murabbi — a spiritual anchor, intention-setting, and a look at today's plan. Mid-morning is a knowledge sprint: a Guide teaches ratio and proportion, because her current *'Amal Project* (a fair water-sharing roster for the school garden) needs it. She then spends a self-paced block in *Manhal* mastering two nodes, her coach checking each gate. After prayer and lunch, the project studio; the day ends with a reflection logged to her *Athar* portfolio. Once a fortnight the class visits a community partner — the gentle start of *Kitab Maftuh*.

2.4 Tafaqquh · Deepen (Year 9-10) — a day in the life

More independence, deeper discipline, first real mentorships. Yusuf (Year 10) runs more of his own week. Two mornings he is off-site at a council sustainability office, working on his *'Amal Project* ("The Cool Courtyard", \$2.7). On campus he pulls heat-transfer and water-cycle nodes from *Manhal* exactly when his calculations need them, books a tutorial with the science Guide, and joins a sprint on technical-report writing. His Murabbi meets him fortnightly for a deeper one-to-one. His evidence — the dataset, the model, the client feedback, the reflection on *adab* with a real client — builds toward his RoSA.

2.5 Riyadah · Lead (Year 11-12) — a day in the life

Highest flexibility, with the HSC held firmly in view. Mariam (Year 12) spends about a day a week in a genuine internship (the Learning-Through-Internship model), and much of her on-campus time in self-paced *Manhal* work and HSC sprints. Her capstone — a *Riyadah* project of real consequence — is supervised by both a Guide and an industry mentor. She still sits her HSC examinations (non-negotiable for Board Developed Courses), and graduates with an *Athar* portfolio and a real professional reference — a young leader, ready to serve.

2.6 The Manhal in practice

Each **node** is the atomic unit: a learning intention; the NESA outcome code(s) it delivers; a visible Bloom badge (Remember → Understand → Apply → Analyse → Evaluate → Create); prerequisites (the upstream links); multi-modal on-demand resources; a mastery check that gates it; and the projects it feeds. A student navigates it like a map: see what is mastered, in progress and next; pull what a project needs; advance on demonstrated mastery, not the clock.

Because every mandatory outcome is tagged to a node *and* a portfolio evidence point, an automated coverage audit guarantees no gaps against a traditional curriculum — with a stronger audit trail.

2.7 An 'Amal Project, fully mapped (worked example)

Tafaqquh-stage (Year 9) 'Amal Project: "The Cool Courtyard" · one term

Design a passive-cooling, water-wise courtyard and an ablution-water re-use concept for a partner mosque, presented to the mosque committee and a council officer. Every phase shows the nodes pulled, when, prerequisites (P) and co-requisites (C), the artefact, the Bloom level and the NESA areas evidenced.

Phase / weeks	Manhal nodes (P=prereq, C=co-req)	Artefact (evidence)	Bloom	NESA areas
Empathise & Define (1-2)	P: client brief; sustainability; urban-heat. C: interviewing	Brief & needs analysis	Understand/ Analyse	English; Geography
Investigate (2-4)	P: measurement; area; scale drawing; data. C: spreadsheets & stats	Site dataset + scaled plan	Apply/Analyse	Maths; Science
Knowledge sprint (4-6)	P: heat transfer; water cycle; evaporative cooling. C: rates & ratios	Thermal & water calcs + diagrams	Apply/Analyse	Science; Maths
Ideate & prototype (6-8)	P: design thinking; materials; intro CAD. C: costing	CAD + physical model; costed proposal	Create/Evaluate	Design & Tech; Maths
Communicate (8-9)	P: report structure; oracy; data viz. C: critique	Technical report + client pitch	Create/Evaluate	English
Majlis & reflect (10)	(synthesis)	Public exhibition + reflective entry	Evaluate/Create	Cross-KLA; values; portfolio

2.8 Assessment, the Athar portfolio and the exam question

- **Mastery is shown many ways** — product, *Majlis* exhibition, portfolio defence/viva, observation, structured tasks — across defined mastery levels.
- **Stages 4-5 (RoSA): no formal exams required.** The RoSA rests on satisfactory completion and grades against syllabus standards; the school chooses the method, and the Athar portfolio is the evidence.
- **Stage 6 (HSC): external examinations are mandatory** for Board Developed Courses. The model wraps the HSC inside Riyadhah projects, but students still sit the exams — state this plainly; knowing the regulator's hard line builds trust.

2.9 Coaching and mentoring requirements, per stage

Stage	Murabbi ratio*	Coaching cadence	Mentoring
Talab · Seek (Y7-8)	~1 : 15	Daily Usrah + weekly 1:1	Guest practitioners; class site visits
Tafaqquh · Deepen (Y9-10)	~1 : 16-18	Daily Usrah + fortnightly deep 1:1	First project mentor (feedback across a project; ~monthly)
Riyadah · Lead (Y11-12)	~1 : 18	Daily Usrah + fortnightly 1:1 + capstone supervision	Sustained internship host (weekly during placement) + academic mentor for HSC & capstone

*Ratios are planning assumptions in the range Big Picture advisories use (≈15-20:1); to be confirmed against the staffing budget.

Part 3 · Industry & community as a working process

Kitab Maftuh is an operating system, not a hope. Industry and community involvement is tiered by stage, screened, scheduled and evidenced — and the accredited teacher always owns the learning.

3.1 Who, what, when, why — by stage

Stage	Who	What they do	When / how often
Talab · Seek (Y7–8)	Guest practitioners; community partners	Talk to a class; host a short site visit; pose a real problem for a project	A few times a term
Tafaquh · Deepen (Y9–10)	Project mentors (industry & community)	Co-set a brief; give feedback at milestones; host half-day visits	Across a project — roughly monthly
Riyadah · Lead (Y11–12)	Internship hosts; capstone supervisors	Provide real workplace tasks; supervise an internship; co-judge the capstone	Weekly during placement (~1 day)

Why it matters: authentic *ilm naafi'* (beneficial knowledge), genuine employability, real references and networks, and the lived experience that turns content into capability — and character.

3.2 The operational machinery — what makes it work

- 1. Curate the network.** The Partnerships Lead builds a host/mentor database with signed MOUs (mosques, councils, businesses, universities, creative practitioners).
- 2. Screen and induct.** Every adult in student contact holds a Working With Children Check and completes a duty-of-care and child-protection induction (NESA B8). A mentor handbook sets expectations.
- 3. Match and schedule.** A platform (ImBlaze-style) matches students to opportunities by interest and project, and schedules them into the week.
- 4. Govern safety off-site.** Risk assessments, transport and supervision protocols, insurance and emergency procedures for every external placement.
- 5. Evidence and sign off.** Industry feedback maps to outcomes via a shared rubric and is logged to the Athar portfolio; the accredited Guide signs off the learning. Mentors enrich; they are not the teacher of record.

Part 4 · The technology, in practice

4.1 The Manara platform stack

Layer	Function	Real options
Delivery LMS	Hosts node resources, comms	Canvas, Moodle (+ add-ons)
Competency / outcomes	Outcome map; gates nodes on mastery	Canvas Outcomes + Mastery Paths; Moodle Competency Frameworks
Adaptive / knowledge-graph	Manhal itself — prerequisites, on-demand pathing	Realizeit (the CSU engine); knowledge-graph tools
Learning Record Store (xAPI)	Captures every learning event, in and out of school	Any xAPI-conformant LRS
Portfolio / credential	The Athar portfolio & transcript	Portfolio tools; Mastery-Transcript model
Real-world / mentor	Curates internships safely	ImBlaze-style platform
Analytics / early-warning	Coverage audit, mastery dashboards, at-risk flags	Built on LRS + LMS data

4.2 What Manara looks like to each person

- **Student:** “my tree” (mastered / in progress / next), my current 'Amal Project, my Athar portfolio, my coverage map, and my next sprint or booked tutorial.
- **Murabbi (coach):** the whole Usrah at a glance — each student’s pace, flags, plan and portfolio completeness.
- **Parent:** their child’s coverage against the mandatory map in plain language, mastery progress, and Majlis invitations — transparency that builds confidence in a non-traditional model.
- **Leadership / NESI inspector:** school-wide coverage assurance, standard-of-teaching evidence, attendance, and the full audit trail — the cleanest inspection artefact a school can offer.

4.3 Build vs buy, and the ‘no-gaps’ guarantee

Recommended posture: start with a configured mainstream LMS + competency layer + an LRS for the opening stage (lowest risk, registrable, affordable, within your expertise); add an adaptive engine once the model is proven and the tree is mature. The **no-gaps guarantee** is a process: a coverage matrix lists every mandatory outcome; the stage’s tree is not ‘ready’ until each maps to a node and a portfolio evidence point; an automated audit re-checks per student each term. Build the data model right; buy sophistication later.

Part 5 • Staffing and salaries (grounded in NSW rates)

5.1 Real NSW salary benchmarks (effective 9 October 2025)

Current NSW Department of Education rates — the public-school scale is the benchmark; independent schools (via the IEU/AIS multi-enterprise agreement) commonly sit around 5–10% higher, with an Accomplished Teacher allowance of \$5,203 (from 1 Feb 2026) and leadership allowances on top.

Role / level	NSW benchmark salary	Basis
Graduate teacher (Step 1)	\$90,177	NSW DoE classroom scale
Top of classroom scale (Step 7)	\$129,536	NSW DoE classroom scale
Highly Accomplished / Lead Teacher	~\$137,861	NSW DoE
Assistant Principal / Head Teacher	\$149,059	NSW DoE leadership
Deputy Principal	\$174,034	NSW DoE leadership
Principal	\$229,435	NSW DoE leadership
Executive Principal	\$245,989	NSW DoE leadership

5.2 The staffing & salary plan, by phase

Role types mostly exist from Year 1 (lean, often part-time); what scales is the number of Domain Guides and Murabbi coaches as cohorts grow, plus HSC subject specialists added as the cohort reaches Stage 6. Salaries are benchmarked to the NSW rates above; FTE counts are planning assumptions on the enrolment basis stated.

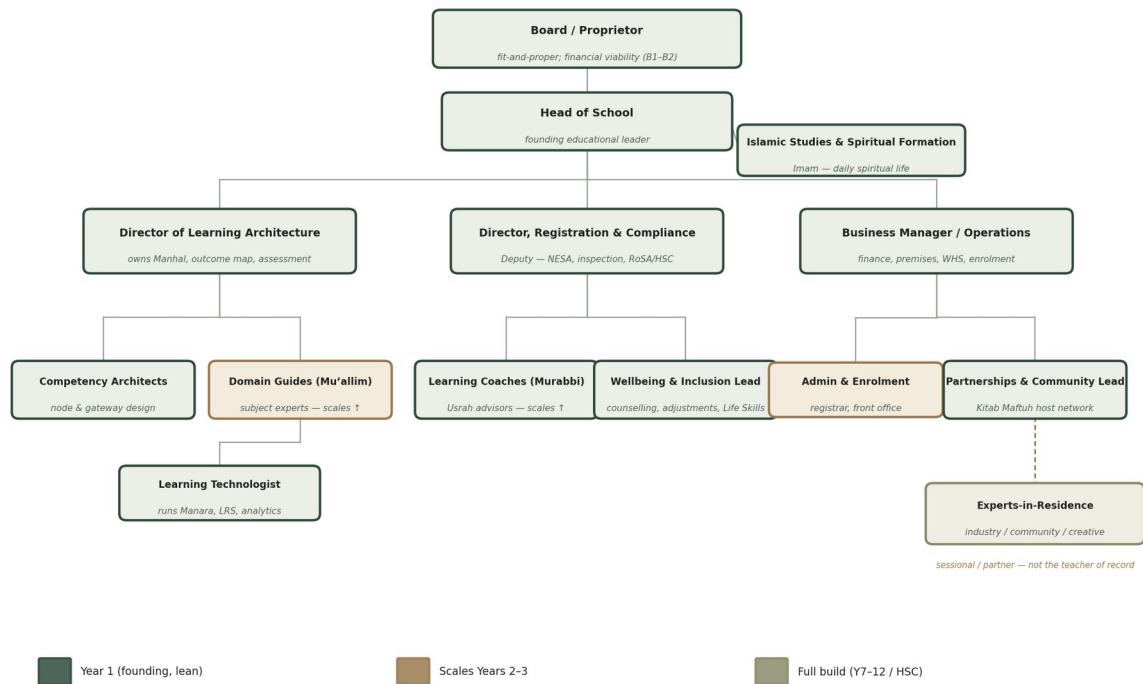
Role	Salary benchmark	Yr1 (Y7 only)	Full (Y7–12)
Head of School	\$210k–\$250k (Principal–Exec Principal band)	1	1
Director, Registration & Compliance	~\$150k–\$175k (Asst/Deputy Principal)	1	1
Director of Learning Architecture	~\$150k–\$175k	1	1
Competency Architects	~\$130k–\$150k (top scale + allowance)	1–2 (build)	2–3
Domain Guides (Mu'allim) — accredited	\$90k–\$130k + allowances	3–4	20–26 (incl. HSC specialists)
Learning Coaches (Murabbi)	teacher scale + coordination allowance	(Guides double)	8–12
Islamic Studies & Spiritual Formation (Imam)	teacher scale + leadership allowance	1	2–3
Wellbeing & Inclusion Lead	~\$130k–\$150k (or P/T + external psych)	0.5–1	2
Learning Technologist (Manara)	~\$90k–\$120k (planning assumption)	0.5–1	1–2
Business Manager / Operations	~\$120k–\$160k (planning assumption)	1	1–2
Partnerships & Community Lead	~\$100k–\$130k (planning assumption)	0.5–1	1–2
Experts-in-Residence	sessional / honoraria / volunteer	via partners	via partners
Indicative total FTE	—	~10–13	~45–55 (=600 students)

Enrolment basis (planning assumption): Year 1 opens with a single Year 7 cohort (=40–60 students); the full school reaches ≈600 across Y7–12. NESA sets no fixed staff ratio — the floor is that every mandatory KLA, and every HSC Board Developed Course offered, is taught by an accredited teacher with safe supervision.

5.3 The phased org chart

Founding Staffing Architecture — phased

Most role types exist from Year 1 (often lean / part-time); Domain Guides and Murabbi coaches scale with each new cohort; HSC subject specialists are added as the cohort reaches Stage 6.



Founding staffing architecture, colour-coded by when each role joins. Guides and Murabbi coaches scale with cohorts; HSC specialists are added by ~Year 4–5.

5.4 The Head-of-School salary, benchmarked

The advertised band (\$210,000–\$250,000) is well-founded: it sits between the NSW **Principal** rate (\$229,435) and **Executive Principal** rate (\$245,989). A \$250,000 expectation is therefore defensible as a top-of-band, founding-leader figure aligned to a substantial NSW principalship — not aspirational.

Part 6 · Pathways to university and the workforce

6.1 How learning and excellence are demonstrated

Five evidence streams, layered: mastery levels recorded in *Manhal*; public *Majlis* exhibitions; the *Athar* portfolio; HSC results; and a graduate-attribute profile (Scholar, Maker, Steward, Communicator, Self-directed learner, Person of character). Excellence is visible, defended and externally witnessed — not reduced to a single number.

6.2 The university pathway

Students sit the HSC and receive an ATAR — the conventional gate is fully preserved. On top of it they carry an *Athar* portfolio of authentic work. With universities increasingly offering early-entry and portfolio-based admission, a graduate who can evidence real capability is advantaged, not disadvantaged. The model widens the door rather than narrowing it.

6.3 The workforce & vocational pathway

Internships through *Kitab Maftuh* produce real references, networks and work samples; VET (Board Endorsed / Content Endorsed) courses can be embedded where relevant; and the portfolio is itself a record of applied competence. A graduate leaves employable, not merely examined.

6.4 The graduate — the 'deep generalist'

The brief asks for graduates who combine academic excellence, spiritual depth, creative problem-solving and moral conviction. The model *manufactures* that profile by design: rigorous knowledge (*Manhal*), applied in consequence ('*Amal + Kitab Maftuh*'), formed in character (*Tarbiyah / Adab*), and evidenced in a body of work (*Athar*). A young leader who is excellent *and* grounded — the operational definition of the school's vision.

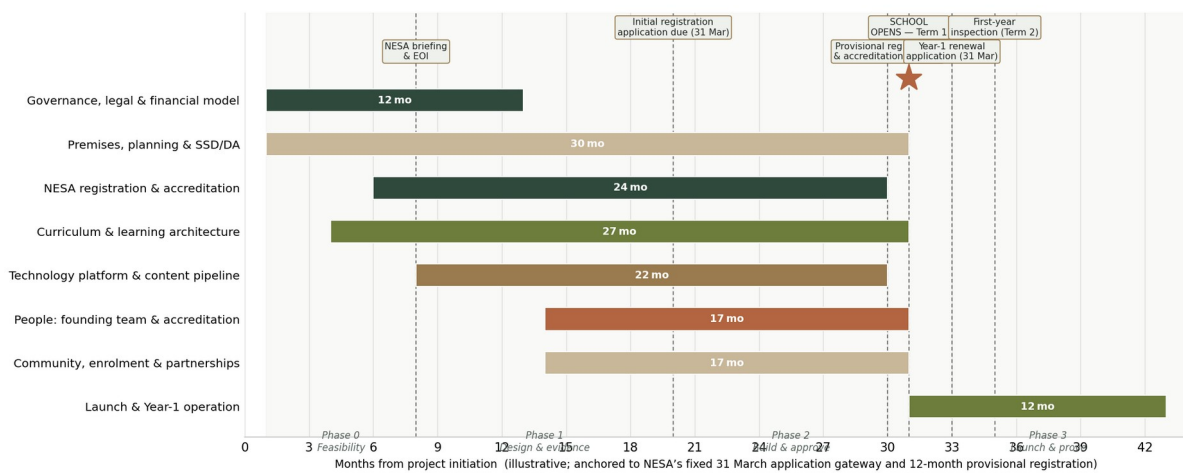
Part 7 · Foundation roadmap & risk

7.1 Phases and gateways

Phase	Focus	Exit gateway
0 — Feasibility	Entity, board, financial model, site search, EOI to NESA	Funded mandate + viable site line-of-sight
1 — Design & evidence	Manhal build, platform, policy suite, NESA briefing	Registration application ready
2 — Build & approve	Submit (31 Mar), recruit team, fit-out, enrolment	Provisional registration granted
3 — Launch & prove	Open Term 1, operate, renew	Pass first-year inspection (Term 2)

7.2 Master schedule (Gantt)

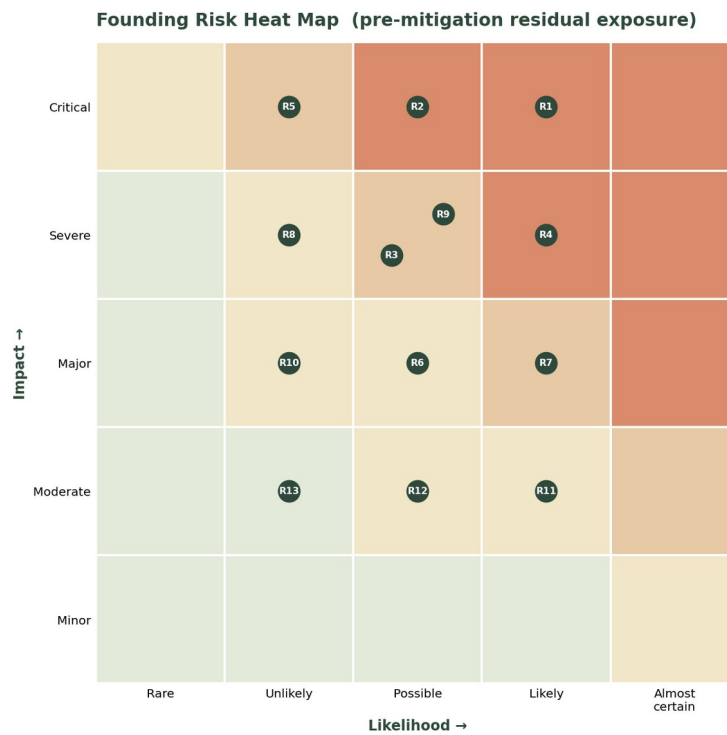
Founding Roadmap — Master Schedule & Critical Gateways



Three items bind everything: the immovable 31 March application date (~9–10 months before a January open); premises/planning (a State Significant Development can take ~24 months); and the opening-stage Manhal, which must be coverage-complete before opening.

7.3 Risk register (pre-mitigation)

ID	Risk	LxI	Mitigation
R1	NESA registration/accreditation delayed or refused	Likely × Critical	Engage NESA early; build evidence from Phase 1; single-stage launch defers accreditation
R2	Premises / planning delay or no site	Possible × Critical	Start in Phase 0; interim leased premises; planning advisers
R3	Manhal not coverage-complete at opening	Possible × Severe	Coverage audit; single-stage scope; AI-assisted authoring + QA; buffer
R4	Cannot recruit aligned, accredited educators	Likely × Severe	Early recruitment; grow-your-own PD; hire for character then train; partner sessionals
R5	Financial viability shortfall (B2.5)	Unlikely × Critical	Conservative enrolment; staged scaling; sponsor runway; sensitivity testing
R6	Family reluctance; soft enrolment	Possible × Major	Transparent evidence; clear HSC pathway messaging
R7	Model-fidelity drift to conventional teaching	Likely × Major	Fidelity rubric; PD; hire for alignment; measure it
R8	Tech stack fails to assure coverage	Unlikely × Severe	Proven mainstream LMS first; pilot before launch
R9	Inspection finds welfare/curriculum gaps	Possible × Severe	Strand A & B readiness from day one; mock inspection
R11	Teacher accreditation not complete in time	Likely × Moderate	Track in recruitment; support staff through NESA early
R12	Insufficient/unsafe internship supply	Possible × Moderate	Build host network early; WWCC + duty-of-care; vet every site



7.4 Scaling logic — the single-stage launch

The move that de-risks everything

Open with Year 7 only, then add one year-level a year. It shrinks the Year-1 Manhal to a single stage, needs a smaller team and less capital, and *defers HSC accreditation* (no senior students for ~4–5 years) so registration is secured first and accreditation added as the cohort reaches Tafaquh and Riyadhah. A terrifying 'open a whole school' problem becomes a manageable 'open one year group well' problem.

Part 8 · Compliance, deployment & sources

Appendix A — NESAs compliance crosswalk

Req.	Requirement	Owner & key evidence
B1	Proprietors & Principals	Board — fit-and-proper persons; Principal suitability
B2	Management & operation	Board — governance, conflict-of-interest, audited financial viability
B3	Staff	Compliance — NESAs-accredited teachers; induction/mentoring/PD
B4	Curriculum	Learning Architecture — syllabus-based programs; coverage audit
B5/B6	Premises & facilities	Business Manager — compliant, fit-for-purpose, safe spaces
B7	Enrolment & attendance	Operations — policies and records (flexible time, attended week)
B8	Safe & supportive environment	Designated officer — child protection, welfare (Strand A)
B9	Discipline	HoS — fair discipline policy
C1/C2	RoSA & HSC curriculum	Compliance — mandatory courses/hours; HSC Board Developed Courses & external exams
C3	Quality of educational program	HoS — standard of teaching & quality of learning (Strand B)

Appendix B — Using this with the Board

- **Open with the connecting idea and the named model** — faith at the centre, Mind/Hands/Heart as one journey; it shows a systems thinker with a brand.
- **Show the worked 'Amal Project, the org chart and the Gantt** — concreteness is what separates you.
- **Lead the risk conversation with the single-stage launch** — the answer that makes the whole thing safe to back.
- **Anchor salary to the NSW principal benchmark** — confident, evidence-based, not aspirational.

Appendix C — Sources & assumptions

Grounded in current NESAs guidance (registration process; Sept-2023 Non-government Schools Manual Part B/C; mandatory curriculum & hours; teacher-accreditation requirements; ACE Rules); the NSW Department of Education salary scale effective 9 October 2025 and IEU/AIS independent-sector loadings; the published Charles Sturt Engineering model; Big Picture Learning (Australia: 40+ campuses, incl. NSW; and internationally) and the Mastery Transcript Consortium; Templestowe College, High Tech High, XP and School 21; and established frameworks (Gold-Standard PBL, Stanford design thinking, Bloom's and SOLO taxonomies, UDL). Names are proposals for review with the school's scholars and community. Ratios, FTE counts, time allocations and enrolment sizing are planning assumptions. Verify all specific NESAs and salary figures against the live sources before relying on them in writing.

Confidential preparation document · a candidate's proposed architecture, not an official school plan.